i/uite unconscious generally of the deeper meaning and the underlying principle of such conduct, which the Hindus as a rule so clearly perceive—it is those of Islam and Islam alone....

'For our own motherland a junction of the two great systems, Hinduism and Islam

— Vedanta brain and Islam body—is the only hope.

'/ see in my mind's eye the future perfect India rising out of this chaos and strife, glorious and invincible, with Vedanta brain and Islam body.' This letter is dated Almora, June

10th, 1898.

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Tagore family had played a leading part in various reform

movements in Bengal during the nineteenth century. There were

men of spiritual stature in it and fine writers and artists, but

Rabindranath towered above them all, and indeed all over India

his position gradually became one of unchallenged supremacy.

His long life of creative activity covered two entire generations

and he seems almost of our present day. He was no politician,

but he was too sensitive and devoted to the freedom of the Indian

people to remain always in his ivory tower of poetry and song.

Again and again he stepped out of it, when he could tolerate

some development no longer, and in prophetic language warned